



COST MODEL

What lost knowledge *actually costs you.*

A simple worksheet to estimate the yearly cost of searching, asking and re-doing work — with the numbers your finance team will accept.

Step 1 — Collect your inputs

- ☐ Number of operational employees (A).
- ☐ Average fully loaded hourly cost, incl. taxes and overhead (B).
- ☐ Minutes per person per day spent searching or asking (C).
- ☐ Working days per year (D), typically 220.
- ☐ Number of onboardings per year (E) and days to productivity (F).

Step 2 — Search and interruption cost

- ☐ Yearly search cost = $A \times (C / 60) \times D \times B$.
- ☐ Example: $120 \text{ people} \times 0.5 \text{ h} \times 220 \text{ days} \times 28 \text{ EUR} = 369,600 \text{ EUR}$.
- ☐ Add interruption cost: every question also stops an expert.
- ☐ Expert cost = questions per day $\times 10 \text{ min} \times \text{expert hourly cost} \times D$.

Step 3 — Onboarding and rework cost

- ☐ Onboarding cost = $E \times F \times B \times 8 \text{ h} \times \text{share of unproductive time}$.
- ☐ Rework cost = incidents per month $\times \text{average cost per incident} \times 12$.
- ☐ Include penalties: late deliveries, failed audits, rejected claims.
- ☐ Include turnover cost when procedures live only in people's heads.

Step 4 — Compare with the fix

- ☐ Assume a conservative 30% reduction of search time in year one.
- ☐ Savings = yearly search cost $\times 0.30$ + onboarding savings.
- ☐ Compare with a self-hosted licence plus your own server cost.
- ☐ Decide on payback months, not on feature lists.

Validate your own numbers in a 30-day pilot

Run OPSQAI on your own server for 30 days, measure how many questions get answered directly from your documents, and compare the result with this worksheet. Apply at opsqai.de/pilot